

THE FULL HOUSE

by

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01/13/2026

Revision: Third (60 Scenes)

The Full House; tells the story of Eddie, a hardworking "house-husband" and small-scale entrepreneur who runs a roadside catering business while raising his teenage daughter, Angela. His wife, Trisha, is a powerhouse executive whose career takes her across the globe, leaving her family behind for months at a time. To Trisha, her financial success is the ultimate proof of love; to Eddie, it is a source of growing resentment and loneliness.

The vacuum Trisha leaves behind does not stay empty for long. Seeing Eddie's vulnerability, their sophisticated divorced neighbor, Amara begins a calculated campaign to replace Trisha, using "help" and seduction to worm her way into the household. Simultaneously, Eddie's meddling mother, fearing her son is being "starved" of a wife's touch, sends Chioma, a raw, uneducated, but fiercely determined girl from the village to take over the home.

As Trisha remains unreachable behind a wall of P.A.s and "unsolicited call" protocols, Eddie finds himself in a domestic war zone. Amara offers him the sophistication he thinks he misses, while Chioma offers the traditional devotion his mother insists he needs.

The tension reaches a breaking point during Angela's 16th birthday party. Trisha makes a surprise return, only to find her "perfect" life has been colonized. She must face the stinging reality that while she was busy building an empire, she was losing her home. In a high-stakes confrontation, Trisha must strip away her corporate armor and fight to win back her husband and daughter from the women who realized that in a marriage, "out of sight" is a dangerous game to play.

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EXT. ROADSIDE - DAY

ANGELA (15, in school uniform) treks down the sparsely populated road.

A Car speeds past her, reverses, stops. The windows slides down, revealing.

EDDIE (30s baked and exhausted, a stew stained apron over his shirt, somewhat heaving at the steering wheel)

EDDIE

Angela!

Angela stops, a mixed expression on her face.

He jerks the door open, Angela enters right next to him. Eddie buckles her in.

Then starts driving.

INT EDDIE'S CAR - CONTINUOUS

EDDIE

Have I not warned you never to trek home, what if someone snatched you?!

ANGELA

Nobody will snatch me Daddy

EDDIE

you're still talking?! This your stubbornness, you can not just obey a simple instruction.

ANGELA

I waited for two hours...

EDDIE

I'm sorry...I was busy at work, but that is not enough reason to risk your life like that. if something should happen to you now, your mother will not let go easily...just do as you're told.

Angela shrugs, turns away.

Eddie is visibly grumbling.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DINING ROOM - EVENING

Angela scribbles on a notebook, Eddie comes out of the adjacent kitchen with a tray of dishes.

EDDIE

Ok clear the table, dinner is ready.

He starts setting dishes, Angela puts her books away. Then settles upright ready to eat.

EDDIE

I have a surprise for you.

He places a dish closed tightly with lid before Angela.

EDDIE

Drumroll!

They both Beatbox a drum beat. Angela adds a trumpet sound.

They laugh.

EDDIE

I said drumroll!

ANGELA

(excited)

Come on, open it!

Eddie pops the lid, revealing a plate of fried rice, turkey and cold slaw.

ANGELA

Ha, I hope this will be sweet.

Eddie grabs his chest, as if having a heart attack.

EDDIE

Not even a thank you, or wow, is that how little you trust my cooking.

ANGELA

(dramatically)

I'm a living, struggling, SURVIVOR of your last fried rice disaster.

The duo laugh.

EDDIE
but this one is extra special ,
because I finally took an online
class and I got it right this time,
just taste it.

He takes a spoonful and feeds her.

ANGELA
(smiles)
Daddy! this is really good, how --
(she takes another spoon herself)
are you sure you didn't buy this?

EDDIE
I don't blame you, you're looking
down on the master of the kitchen.

ANGELA
This is too good to be true.

The doorbell blares off.

EDDIE
Carry on, I'll get it.

He beelines to the door, opens it.

We meet TRISHA (30s, sophisticated in a power suit matching
her designer hand bag) she's on a call, on the other hand
is a pile of office files.

As soon as the door opens up, she carefreely dumps her
files and hand bag on Eddie's hands.

TRISHA
(into phone)
Yes, yes we're moving to Q2

She enters the house, takes off her shoes and throws them
all over.

TRISHA (CONT'D)
(into phone)
I'll be sending sixty-two million to
Ahmed, so he can renew all the
licenses and clear those goods
before June...yeah ...ok, ok.

Eddie Picks up the loose shoes, in addition to the
overflowing documents, dropping from his hands at every
slight movement.

EDDIE
Trisha, I didn't know you were
coming.

Trisha holds up a straight finger "Shushing" Eddie.

She takes off her jacket and throws it back, it lands
almost on his face.

She's gradually making her way towards the bedroom but the
phone call is slowing her.

Angela spots Trisha and runs over from the dinning area.

ANGELA
(excited)
Mummy you're back!

Angela spreads her hand to hug Trisha. Trisha blocks her by
holding her at a distance, then pushing her towards Eddie
behind.

TRISHA
(into phone)
... please can you give me a
minute, I need to handle something
real quick.

She ends the call, a frown on her face.

TRISHA
(to eddie and angela)
What is wrong with the both of you!
Can't you see I'm making an
important call?

EDDIE
Sorry if it-

TRISHA
Sorry for yourself!!!

She hisses and storms off.

The room is tense.

Angela is dumbfounded.

ANGELA
I just wanted -

EDDIE
It's nothing, Mummy is just a
little stressed out, that's all, go
and eat.

Suddenly Trisha comes back out of the room in a new suit,
with a new hand bag and some files.

She hurries to meet Eddie and rummages through the files in
his possession, many dropping to the floor, she picks out a
document and tucks it into her bag then heads for the door.

Eddie immediately dumps everything on the floor.

EDDIE
(pissed)
Trisha! where are you going?

TRISHA
What sort of question is that?!

EDDIE
you're seriously asking me that?
you've been away for three weeks
and you come back, just so you can
leave again?

TRISHA
Didn't you get the email my
assistant sent you? I told her to
tell you I have another business
trip...

ANGELA
How long will you be gone this
time?

TRISHA
Oh baby it's not too long, just a
quick trip to South Africa, then
Madagascar and an extra few days in
Ghana then back to Nigeria...home.

She smiles sheepishly, pulls out her phone and starts
typing.

EDDIE
you're not leaving this house!

TRISHA
Don't even think about throwing
tantrums like a child, we both know
who foots the bills.

EDDIE

You're not going to play that card because I work, and for the past few years I've been taking care of Angela and myself on my personal account.

TRISHA

Because you refused to take my money! If not what exactly do you do for a living? do you think real men sell small chops by the roadside in this economy?...or it's your small chops business that pays for this house... Eddie better respect yourself and not get on my nerves.

She's still typing on her phone.

ANGELA

Mummy but you said you'd be around for my football game in school this Friday.

TRISHA

There will be plenty more games, don't worry I'll buy you a basketball from South Africa.

EDDIE

She said football, your daughter, our child plays football, you definitely don't know that because you're not listening.

TRISHA

Football, basketball, they're all balls... Angela am I right?

Angela stares at her deadpan.

TRISHA

Whatever.

She jerks the door open and exits.

Angela walks over to Eddie, who wraps his arms around her in an embrace.

EDDIE
Don't worry, she'll be back very soon, and when she gets back I'll make sure we get VIP seats at your next football game, you hear.

Angela reluctantly nods.

EDDIE
Oya food critique come and finish the rice.

He bumps her, she forces a smile that immediately fades the moment Eddie looks away.

FADE OUT.

FADEIN:

EXT. FAMILY HOUSE - DAY

Eddie is sweeping the driveway.

AMARA (late 20s, plumpy, pretty, in skin tight sports wear) comes out of the building next door.

Amara waves at him, then approaches.

AMARA
Good morning...

EDDIE
Good morning...ah I haven't seen this face before, you came to visit someone?

AMARA
No I'm your new neighbor...Amara.

EDDIE
Eddie...I mean Edison but everyone calls me Eddie.

EDDIE
You're with your husband?

AMARA
No. Divorced, he was an error.

EDDIE
Oh...ok...It's really nice to meet you, we haven't had a neighbor in years.

AMARA

Wow I guess I have to make sure I'm
the best next door person you'd
ever have.

They both laugh.

AMARA

Ok see you around.

She jogs off, Eddie returns to sweeping.

CUT TO:

EXT. FAMILY HOUSE - AFTERNOON

Eddie is hanging washed clothes on a cloth line outside.

Angle on Amara's House, she comes out to the balcony in a
short dress, watching him.

After a short while, she approaches.

AMARA

don't you get tired?

EDDIE

(chuckles)

if I got tired who will do this
work then?...I have to tidy things
up before my daughter comes back
from school.

AMARA

Oh you have a daughter?

EDDIE

Yes, Angela.

AMARA

I don't meet alot of hardworking
men, like for real you've been out
here working before I went out for
my workouts, then came back made
breakfast. you should consider
getting yourself a househelp, at
least to slow things down, you
don't want to work yourself to
death.

Eddie hangs the last shirt, he exhales.

AMARA
See what I'm talking about?

Eddie yawns.

EDDIE
I'll be fine, I do this everyday.

AMARA
All by yourself? What about your wife?

EDDIE
She's on a business trip.

Yawns again.

AMARA
Have you had anything to eat yet?

Eddie shakes his head.

EDDIE
I'll make some noodles.

AMARA
Noodles after all that work, no, that's unacceptable.

EDDIE
I'm fine

AMARA
I can't watch you starve, I'm going to make you something to eat.

EDDIE
No, no I don't want to bother you.

AMARA
don't worry, I don't mind.

She grabs his bucket from the floor, as they proceed inside the house.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LATER

Eddie is eating like a wolf, while Amara pours him a glass of juice.

EDDIE
(mouthful)
I haven't eaten anything like this
in years, you're so good.

AMARA
I learnt from the best.

She sits uncomfortably too close to Eddie, he shifts away
from her a little, she smiles and shifts closer.

AMARA
so your wife travels like this
often?...

Eddie nods.

EDDIE
There was one time she spent the
whole year in Canada.

AMARA
Jeez...this her recent trip, how
long has she been gone?

She runs her hand over his shoulder.

EDDIE
(timid)
Two months now.

AMARA
Two months? What kind of a trip is
that?

EDDIE
She'll be back by next week, so
it's almost over...I mean she's
making money...plus I married a
wife not a househelp... right?

AMARA
Do you really believe what you just
said?

EDDIE
Yeah, we're in a different era,
gender roles shouldn't really be a
thing.

AMARA

But she's your wife and no matter
what civilization says, a wife has
duties, to her husband, her
marriage and her daughter.

EDDIE

(uncomfortable, looking away)
can we... can we not talk about
this? please.

AMARA

(softening her voice, smiling)
I'm sorry. I didn't mean to
overstep. You're a good man, Eddie.
Too good, maybe. I'll let you
finish your food in peace.

She stands up, patting his shoulder gently, a lingering
touch and heads for the door.

AMARA

See you later, neighbor.

CUT TO:

EXT.DRIVEWAY- EVENING

Angela is practicing her football skills, kicking a ball
against the wall. Eddie is on a ladder , trying to fix a
faulty security light overhead.

EDDIE

Angela , stop that kicking, the
vibration is shaking the whole
pillar!

ANGELA

Sorry Daddy! , one more goal!

She takes a powerful shot,It misses the goal and hits the
base of the ladder.The ladder wobbles violently.

EDDIE

Whoa! Whoa!

Eddie loses his balance and slides down the ladder. He
doesn't fall flat, but his leg gets caught in the rungs. He
hits the pavement with a loud thud followed by a groan of
pain.

ANGELA
(running over, panicked)
Daddy!, daddy!!, I'm sorry!!!

Eddie is clutching his ankle, face contorted.

EDDIE
(gritting his teeth)
It's okay... I'm okay... just...
help me up.

He tries to stand, but his ankle gives way. He hisses in pain. From the balcony next door, Amara appears, already moving toward them.

AMARA
(calling out)
Eddie I'm coming!

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - NIGHT

The living room is dimly lit. Angela is asleep on the small sofa, a blanket draped over her.

Eddie is on the main couch, his leg elevated on a pillow with a bandage wrapped around his ankle.

Amara carries Angela off to bed, she returns shortly after and beelines to the kitchen.

AMARA
Would you like a drink?

Amara comes out of the kitchen , with two glasses of wine. She walks over, handing one to Eddie.

EDDIE
Thank you. For everything. Putting
Angela to bed, the first aid... I
don't know what I would have done.

AMARA
(Sitting on the edge of the center
table, facing him)
You would have struggled alone.
Like you always do.

EDDIE
It's part of the job description.

AMARA
No, Eddie. It's the responsibility
of married couples. But you're
doing your marriage alone.

A heavy silence falls between them. Eddie takes a long sip
of the wine. He looks exhausted, defeated by the day's
events.

AMARA
So... be honest with me.

EDDIE
About what?

AMARA
Your wife has been gone for two
months. She didn't call when you
got hurt. She didn't even pick up.

Eddie looks away, his jaw tightening.

AMARA
Do you have someone else? Someone
who actually checks on you?

EDDIE
(timid)
I don't know what you're talking
about. I'm married.

AMARA
(moving from the table to the
couch, sitting very close)
Come on. What is the matter? I
won't bite. Look... you can't
possibly tell me your wife travels
for a year and you don't have
someone else.

She runs her hand slowly up his thigh, near the edge of his
shorts. Eddie freezes.

AMARA
(leaning in, whispering)
You know she's cheating on you,
right? It's always one business
trip after another. It's either
with her secretary or the boss.
While you're here playing house
girl, she's being a woman for
someone else.

EDDIE
I... I trust Trisha. She can't do
such a thing. That is why I
can't... I can't do this

She leans in and kisses him, hard. Eddie is trapped for a second, the kiss lingering before he finally shoves her shoulders back.

EDDIE
Stop! Stop it! Amara, leave! Now!

AMARA
(amused)
you're joking right -

EDDIE
Please go!

AMARA
(standing up, smoothing her dress,
unbothered)
I was just...
(beat. smiles)
I'm just offering a cure.

She heads for the door, pausing with her hand on the knob.

AMARA
If you ever change your mind... I'm
just next door.

She exits. Eddie stares at the closed door, his chest heaving. He looks at his phone on the table, still no calls from Trisha.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - MOMENTS LATER

Eddie dials on his phone, buzzes, receiver answers.

EDDIE
(into phone)
Trisha, babe...urm something
happened, I just feel like I should
talk to you, we haven't really
talked in a while.

A BEAT

P.A (V.0)
 (from phone)
 Hello please Mrs Trisha Alade
 doesn't respond to unsolicited
 calls or texts, if you want to talk
 to her send an email to
 Info@TrishaAlade.com and you'll be
 guided on your next steps thank
 you.

EDDIE
 (into phone)
 What?! What is the meaning of this,
 why can't I talk to my wife!

P.A(V.0)
 (from phone)
 This is standard procedure sir.

EDDIE
 (into phone)
 If you don't pass that phone to my
 wife this instant, I'll make sure
 she sacks you!

P.A(V.0)
 (stern)
 send an email, book an appointment.

Cuts the call.

Eddie pulls the phone away from his ear, defeated.

EDDIE
 Email to talk to my own wife.

He exclaims.

CUT TO:

EXT. ROADSIDE - DAY

Angela is in school uniform sitting on the curb.

Amara's car speeds into frame, it stops in front of Angela,
 windows slide down.

AMARA
 Angela is that you? Come let me
 take you home.

Angela approaches the car window.

ANGELA
I'm not sure my dad would
approve...

AMARA
Let me call him

She dials on her phone.

AMARA
(into phone)
I just saw Angela, I want to bring
her home...
(beat)
ok, ok let me give her the phone.

Amara passes the phone to Angela.

Angela presses it against her ear.

ANGELA
(into phone)
Hello Daddy...
(beat)
Ok Daddy.
(to amara)
He said I should come with you.

She hands the phone back to Amara who ends the call, Angela enters the car, as she buckles.

AMARA
(smiles)
You know...there's this new ice
cream place along the estate road,
what do you say we stop by and get
your father a snack.

ANGELA
(Excited)
Let's go , let's go.

AMARA
Calm down, we'll be there in no
time.

They exchange smiles.

CUT TO;

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Eddie hurries into frame, an apron slung on, rubbing his

minted hands together.

Almost instantly the door pops open, Amara and Angela come in with cups of ice cream.

EDDIE

Ah you guys got snacks already-

ANGELA

(hyper)

Auntie Amara bought us donuts, I ate two, then she also got us ice cream...I collected Vanilla flavor but I didn't like it, so we switched.

Amara settles into a chair, with a wide smile she waves her cup at Eddie.

AMARA

We actually got you one but Angela ate it.

EDDIE

Angela!

ANGELA

I couldn't resist.

They all laugh.

AMARA

So what have you been busy with in the kitchen?

EDDIE

Nothing much, i baked a few egg rolls and buns.

AMARA

Hmmm I definitely want to taste this.

ANGELA

You should, my dad makes the best.

AMARA

all this hype-

EDDIE

(laughs)

It's worth it

Amara stretches out her hand, Eddie helps her up, they all

proceed into the kitchen.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - EVENING

There are several plates of small chops on the table, some beverages, the TV is showing and animated film.

We see Amara trying out a pie.

While Eddie and Angela cheer her on.

She takes a bite, chews and returns a smile.

Angela nudges Amara to feed Eddie, Eddie waves in refusal, Angela makes a cute sad face, Eddie reluctantly agrees, Amara feeds Eddie.

- Angle on the TV it's now showing a music video, Angela takes the floor, excited she dances to the choreography on screen.

She proceeds to drag Eddie on his feet, He dances awkwardly, She tries to coach him.

Then drags Amara on her feet as well, the trio are dancing silly.

We pan off.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DINNING ROOM - LATER

The table is cluttered with a couple of text books, Angela and Amara are up close working out a math problem on a notebook.

Eddie enters watches them from behind.

Angela suddenly giggles, she gives Amara a "high five".

Eddie coughs to notify them of his presence.

ANGELA

Daddy auntie Amara helped me with
all my assignments...

(she shows eddie her books)

See.

EDDIE

Wow that's amazing...why...why
 didn't you come to me, you always
 come to me.

ANGELA

I wanted Auntie Amara to do it,
 (whispers)
 Plus she knows Algebra.

AMARA

Angela don't tease your dad.

EDDIE

Thank you Amara, I really
 appreciate...well I guess it's time
 for bed.

Angela packs her books, then heads up to her room.

ANGELA

Good night Daddy, good night auntie
 Amara... don't forget to pick me up
 tomorrow after school...you
 promised.

EDDIE

(to amara)
 You did?

AMARA

(to angela)
 I will not forget it for anything
 in the world.

ANGELA

Tomorrow then.

She runs off screen.

EDDIE

you're her personal driver now?

AMARA

Not really, but I made her a
 promise and I'm going to keep it.

EDDIE

Ok...
 (sighs)
 About today I wasn't really
 expecting -

Amara stands up and walks up to stand face to face with

Eddie.

AMARA
It's nothing, I mean it's the least
I could do.

EDDIE
I don't understand.

Amara throws her arms around his neck.

AMARA
No man as good as you should have
to do all this alone...I did what I
did just to show you that I can
definitely be helpful around...

Eddie shifts back uncomfortably.

EDDIE
Amara I can't give you what you
want.

AMARA
Me? What do I want?...I don't want
anything o... what you should be
more concerned with is what you
want.

EDDIE
I don't want to cheat on my wife.

Amara presses herself against him, he's cornered.

AMARA
Is it really cheating if she's
cheating too.

EDDIE
(annoyed)
My wife is not cheating on me, stop
saying that!

AMARA
But she is, that's why she's not
here right now!

EDDIE
Amara that's enough, you need to
go.

Amara kisses him.

EDDIE
You need to leave this minute, Go!

She forces herself on him, Eddie doesn't resist, she starts unbuttoning his shirt.

Suddenly-

ANGELA (O.C)
Daddy! the water tap is broken again!

Angela walks into frame wearing an oversized bath robe.

Eddie and Amara instantly jump apart.

EDDIE
(frantic)
how many times have I told you not to wear my robe!

ANGELA
Mine got wet, the water tap-

EDDIE
(cuts in)
you've broken it again?!

AMARA
Eddie calm down.

He storms off into the room, Angela and Amara exchange a look of confusion, Angela runs after him.

Amara sits back on the dinner table, reveling.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - BEDROOM - LATER

Eddie enters his room.

ANGELA (O.C)
Ok thank you Daddy, good night!

EDDIE
Good...good night

He shuts the door, rests his head on the frame for a while, then slumps down to sit on the floor.

The room seems to spin.

FADE TO BLACK.

Door bell ringing

FADE IN:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - MORNING

Eddie jerks the door open, we find Chioma (20s in a saggy , oversized 80s looking gown, her hair dressed in plastic thread) she's hugging a small "Ghana must go" bag to her breasts, constantly wearing a sheepish smile.

She flashes a small note.

CHIOMA

Oga sir, my names are Udoka
Chukwuebuka Chioma, my friends call
me ChiChi, isn't this the correct
place in address.

EDDIE

What?

CHIOMA

Address.

Waves the note.

Eddie snatches the note and reads through.

EDDIE

Yes this is my house address, who
gave you this?

CHIOMA

you're Oga Edison Odiohon

EDDIE

Yes

(catches himself)

No, it's Edison Odion no extra
"hon" , who gave you my address?

CHIOMA

Mama, big mama for village.

EDDIE

My mother?

Chioma nods.

EDDIE

My mother sent you here?

Chioma nods.

CHIOMA

(dramatical hand gestures)

Mama's Pastor for village told her you're suffering, your wife is using you as slave, and making you to suffering, so Mama feel bad, very bad, she send Chioma to come here and make you feel good.

EDDIE

As how?

CHIOMA

Chioma can clean the house with broom and soap, Chioma washes the clothes, Chioma cleaning the television she doesn't spoilt it o, Chioma can do the bed, Chioma taking care of mama grand pikin well well, Chioma can cook concoction rice, groundnut oil rice, coconut rice, beans, porridge, yam and plantain, Chioma makes eba and Fufu, sweet egusi soup, Edikan ikon, Oha, ofe oweri, better correct abacha-

EDDIE

Stop!

(beat)

So you're a maid

CHIOMA

Ah, you gotten it wrong o, Mama in village did not send Chioma as maid o, Mama want second pikin, Mama want you to be happy, so Chioma clean, cook, take care of Mama grand pikin and take care of Edison Odiohon in the night...

EDDIE

In the what?

CHIOMA
 (spreads her arms in description)
 In the sleeping room, Chioma open
 it, open it for Oga Edison
 Odiohon...make Oga happy and give
 Mama second pikin.

Eddie's eyes go wide.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - MOMENTS LATER

Eddie is on his phone.

EDDIE
 (raged)
 Mama what's the meaning of this
 nonsense, you sent me a wife from
 the village?!
 When you know I am married!!! I am
 sending her back!!!

We hear his Mother in voice over, her voice sounding like
 she's at the brink of tears.

MOTHER(V.O)
 (from phone)
 You want me to fold my hands Edison
 when that witch you call a wife
 wants to work you to death! Edison
 if you send that innocent girl
 Chioma out of your house, I'll die
 and the entire family will know
 you're the one that killed me.

EDDIE
 (into phone)
 Mama it hasn't gotten to that...I
 can't do anything with this Chioma
 girl, it'll ruin my marriage.

MOTHER(V.O)
 As far as I'm concerned you're
 single...I went through alot to get
 Chioma's parents to allow me send
 her to the city, she'll take care
 of you and whenever you're ready
 we'll go and see her people.

EDDIE
 (into phone)
 She can't even speak English!

Mother ends the call.

EDDIE
(into phone)
Hello? Mum, mummy!

He takes the phone away from his ear.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Eddie leads Chioma into the house.

CHIOMA
(excited)
Oga sir, you have big house o...
Mansion!!!, Chioma will be madam in
big Mansion!!!

EDDIE
Hey, stop it!
(beat)
You're not a madam here, listen
you're not my wife, you're not
going to be doing anything in this
house other than chores.

CHIOMA
But Mama said-

EDDIE
It doesn't matter what my mother
said, I'll pay you salary for the
months you'll work here and that
will be untill I can get rid of you
without giving my mother a heart
attack.

CHIOMA
Oga Edison Odiohon no like Chioma?

EDDIE
And yes call me sir or Eddie.

CHIOMA
But Chioma is fine o

She turns around, showcasing her butt and breasts.

EDDIE
Chioma is not my type! and I'm
MARRIED!...

(beat)
 (hisses)
 Come let me show you your room

CHIOMA
 Our room?

EDDIE
 If you don't respect yourself I'll
 send you out into the streets.

Chioma wears a sad face, she reluctantly follows Eddie into the room.

CUT TO

INT . FAMILY HOUSE - AFTERNOON

Angela returns from school, she's accompanied by Amara.

Chioma in a different saggy 80's style dress comes to grace them.

CHIOMA
 (sheepishly)
 Good afternoon step pikin, good
 afternoon fine sister.

AMARA
 Who is this?

ANGELA
 I don't know her-
 (to chioma)
 does my father know you're in here?

CHIOMA
 (laughs)
 see your big big sweet oyibo!

AMARA
 Young lady who the hell are you?

CHIOMA
 Why are you shouting, are you Oga
 Edison rubbish wife that refuse to
 remain in the marriage?

AMARA
 I am not his wife-

CHIOMA
Then you shutting your mouth when
I'm talking to my step pikin!

AMARA
What does that even mean?

CHIOMA
(puffs with pride)
If you must want to know, I am
Udoka Chukwuebuka Chioma my friends
call me ChiChi, Chi Baby and Oga
Edison Odiohon Mama for village
send me to come and be him new
wife!

ANGELA
What?!

AMARA
What?!

CHIOMA
Yes you're my step pikin and -
(slaps her belly)
And I will born many, many new
pikin, boys for Oga Edison Odiohon,
your step brothers and sisters!

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - ANGELA'S BEDROOM - EVENING

Angela and Eddie are sitting face to face, her in the bed,
Eddie on an arm chair.

EDDIE
Look she's not my new wife, Grandma
is just worried that something bad
might happen to me due to the
stress of working and caring for
you alone...Chioma is just here to
help out.

ANGELA
But we have Auntie Amara, she helps
out.

EDDIE
Amara is our neighbor and I don't
really think it's ok to let her-

Stops abruptly.

ANGELA
What?, let her what?

EDDIE
All I'm just saying is that she has
her own life to live.

ANGELA
This Chioma lady is very
troublesome, and she wants to marry
you.

EDDIE
She's not going to marry me,
believe me, once I can talk to
Grandma we're sending Chioma back
to the village, I promise you.

A beat.

ANGELA
Ok Daddy.

EDDIE
Ok now, get some rest.

Angela tucks herself into bed, Eddie swaths her with a
duvet.

EDDIE
Sleep tight.

ANGELA
I hope You don't hate auntie Amara?

EDDIE
(sighs)
No I don't

ANGELA
Good Because I like her, she's...my
friend.

She sleeps off.

Eddie exits the room.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Chioma is spread out on the couch, snoring loudly.

Eddie walks into frame, he taps her several times till she wakes.

CHIOMA
Oga, Oga sir

EDDIE
I showed you your room why are you sleeping here?

CHIOMA
I was waiting for you nau.

EDDIE
For what?

CHIOMA
to go to our room.

EDDIE
Chioma! Go to the room I showed you!

Chioma stands up, she scratches her body all over, a little drowsy, she walks off frame.

Eddie starts arranging the couch pillows.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - EDDIE'S ROOM - NIGHT

Eddie comes out of the bathroom, bare, a towel around his waist.

CHIOMA (O.C)
Oga Edison Odiohon...my love I've wait for you tire.

Eddie turns immediately in shock.

Angle on Chioma on the bed, wrapping herself with the blankets.

EDDIE
What are you doing here?!

CHIOMA
Oga sir it's time

EDDIE
Time for what?!

CHIOMA
I open it for you now, I'll
submissive to you as my husband.

She sits up in the bed.

EDDIE
Get out!

CHIOMA
You don't want submissive?

EDDIE
Leave my room this minute!

CHIOMA
(dramatically making descriptive
gestures with her hand)
I can be multipurpose, I do
submissiving, I can be overtaking
you, doing the fighting style, I
even sabi snake in the monkey
shadow...my former boyfriend from
village he sabi the thing well
well, we do it many many times, in
the bush, in the motor, in the
stream, under the tree, in the
Forbidden forest, so he teach me,
till he go to prison.
(she shakes her chest)
Oga Edison Odiohon climb bed let me
show you the love.

Eddie charges, drags her off the bed.

CHIOMA
Oh you want to do it the standing
one...

Eddie pushes her out of the room.

CHIOMA
Oga Edison let me show you the love
nau.

Eddie slams the door shut.

INT.FAMILY HOUSE-OUTSIDE THE DOOR - CONTINUOUS

Chioma is leaned against the door frame.

CHIOMA
 (Wails)
 Oga Edison Odiohon o! Oga Edison
 Odiohon o!

The door swings open, Eddie comes out swinging a belt, She takes to her heels, he chases her off screen.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DINNING ROOM - MORNING

Eddie and Angela come to sit at the table.

Chioma brings dishes and sets them.

She opens them, it's Fufu and soup.

EDDIE
 This is too heavy for breakfast.

CHIOMA
 Oga sir, in the village we eat this
 to breaking the fast, we eat it to
 breaking the afternoon, we eat this
 to breaking the night... strong
 Fufu good for the body.

EDDIE
 My daughter -

ANGELA
 Dad it's delicious

CHIOMA
 Gbam!

Angle on Angela eating the food. Eddie reluctantly joins in.

EDDIE
 Ok, ok, but this evening consult me
 so I'll tell you what to make for
 tomorrow.

CHIOMA
 Ok Oga sir...oga sir you like my
 food?

EDDIE
 It's ok.

CHIOMA
 (excited)
 Come and see o, my Oga is liking my
 soup o, my Oga love me too much o.

EDDIE
 Stop!

A long beat.

CHIOMA
 Sorry Oga sir.

The doorbell rings.

CHIOMA
 I'll getting the door.

She walks away.

EDDIE
 (to angela)
 You really like it?.

Angela nods.

EDDIE
 She's a good cook but we can't eat
 like this, you'll become fat.
 (he puffs his cheeks)
 You want everybody to be calling
 you orobokibo.

ANGELA
 (laughs)
 Mummy said you used to be orobo-

EDDIE
 (shuns her playfully)
 Eat you food!

Amara and Chioma enter the room.

EDDIE
 You're here.

He stands up washes his hands, wipes them with a towel and
 proceeds to hugging Amara.

AMARA
 you smell nice

EDDIE
 It's just my old cologne.

AMARA
Is there a reason for it?

EDDIE
Meeting with a friend, yeah I was going to ask if you could drop me off as well, my brakes are bad.

AMARA
Can I tag along and bring you home after.

EDDIE
No problem, let me just get my stuff.

He runs off screen.

Angela cleans up, puts on her bag.

ANGELA
Auntie Amara I'll be in the car...
(to chioma)
I really love the food, you'll teach me when I get back from school.

CHIOMA
I teaching you everything, don't worry, take care you hear.

Angela leaves as well.

Amara is standing idle, she turns to see Chioma staring directly at her with a heavy frown, Amara looks around as if looking for who Chioma is looking at.

AMARA
Is something wrong with your face?

CHIOMA
Heyssss! Hold it there! you thinking I don't know what all this your "kurukere" is about...I Chioma understanding very well I went to school primary two, I knowing what is going on here.

AMARA
I don't know what you're talking about.

Chioma walks up to Amara, uncomfortably too close.

CHIOMA

Oga Edison Odiohon is my own, him
Mama for village dash him to me,
not you, Angela is my step pikin,
not your own, this family is my
own, go and find your own, stop
trying to thief my man from me!

Eddie enters the room.

EDDIE

What is going on here?

CHIOMA

I've say my mind o

She shrugs and walks off.

AMARA

I don't get this, are you really
marrying her or something?

EDDIE

She's the house keeper

AMARA

Who's going around telling people
she's your village wife

EDDIE

She doesn't know what she's saying

AMARA

Then sack her!

EDDIE

It's complicated

AMARA

Or you're doing something with that
dirty ancient girl... aren't you.

EDDIE

No

AMARA

To think I thought you had class,
imagine me having to fight over you
with that thing!

EDDIE

(yells)

Nobody is fighting over me!

(beat)

I am married, why does everyone
keeps forgetting that.

AMARA
Married to a village pig.

She side steps him and storms out.

Eddie is dumbfounded, he throws his arms in the air in
complaint, then follows behind.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DAY

Eddie's on the couch, flipping through a magazine, his
phone rings.

We see the caller, it's Trisha.

He answers.

EDDIE
Hello-

INTERCUT:

INT. TRISHA'S CAR - SAME TIME

Trisha is sitting in the back, her eyes peeled on the road,
as she holds her phone to her ear.

TRISHA
Eddie how have you been?

EDDIE
I'm exactly where you left me and
Angela, whom I should remind you is
your flesh and blood.

TRISHA
She's no longer a kid and she knows
exactly why I have to be away for a
while

EDDIE
(snaps)
This is not "a while" Trisha, "a
while" is like three days, but
you've been off for almost two
months now... Trisha you're letting
Angela grow up without a mother.

TRISHA
Would you prefer I let her grow up
in poverty?!

EDDIE
Oh don't give me that money crap!

TRISHA
Eddie I'm building an empire,
generational wealth...I wish you
could understand but I guess you
lack the vision...wait until Angela
turns 20 and sees the huge trust
fund I've put up for her.

EDDIE
Yes by then she'll hate you and
want nothing to do with you.

TRISHA
well that's her own cup of tea, not
that I came to this life to seek a
child's validation anyways.

EDDIE
You're sick! Selfish and self
centered.

TRISHA
Before you start calling me names,
I actually called because I forgot
a very important document, I'd like
you to waybill it over to my
secretary who'd bring it to me.

EDDIE
If you want your documents you have
to come get them yourself.

TRISHA
(calming voice)
Edison, calm down, relax you're
always hot tempered...I promise
just waybill this files to me and
I'll come back home and spend time
with the family, just do this favor
for me please.

EDDIE
No and don't call me over this
again.

He cuts the call.

Trisha slams her hands on the driver's backrest in frustration.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - CONTINUOUS -

Eddie dumps the phone on the couch and returns to his magazine.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - KITCHEN - LATER

Chioma is teaching Angela how to cook. Remnants of ingredients sprawled out on the table. The duo in stained aprons.

Chioma takes the lid off a boiling pot of egusi soup.

CHIOMA
Angela my step pikin you're natural!

ANGELA
I'm a natural?

CHIOMA
Ehen! Yes! you Sabi am well well...

She takes a spoon, stirs the pot, then puts a drop of soup on her palm and tastes it.

CHIOMA
(smacking her lips)
You go add small salt.

Angela sprinkles in the salt, Chioma stirs and repeats her tasting process.

CHIOMA
(smiles)
Very, very good.

ANGELA
(excited)
Wow, I made egusi soup! Wait till I tell Daddy, he's not going to believe this!

CHIOMA
He go believe, he go believe.

ANGELA
So are we making fufu or eba?

CHIOMA

Wait first step pikin Angela...see
this thing I'm teaching you, you go
help me with something.

ANGELA

I don't have any money.

CHIOMA

No be money, I wanted you to teach
me big oyibo, yes, teach me all the
many big oyibo that Oga Edison
Odiohon likes, make I spoken am to
him.

ANGELA

I don't know big oyibo.

CHIOMA

But you spoke it to me just now
now.

A beat

ANGELA

Ok...ok I'll teach you anything you
want to learn.

CHIOMA

Ehen!, I teach you soup, you teach
me big big oyibo.

ANGELA

I guess we have a deal.

She stretches her hand for a shake.

CHIOMA

(excited)

You spoke it to me again!

Chioma snatches her hand, shaking it awkwardly fast.

Angela laughs.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DINNING ROOM - LATER

Eddie, Chioma and Angela are sitting at the table eating,
there's laughs across the table.

We close up on Eddie as he watches Chioma and Angela talk ,
tease and laugh.

FADE OUT.

FADE IN:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - ANGELA'S BEDROOM - EVENING

Chioma is sitting on the bed, Angela has a small dictionary in hand, she shows Chioma words and tries to get her to pronounce.

ANGELA
the correct one is "he is speaking
to me" not "he is spokening it to
me".

CHIOMA
Ehen nau, same thing I said,
spoken-ing.

ANGELA
Speaking

CHIOMA
Speaking-ing it to me

ANGELA
(slaps her forehead in frustration)
No, it's speaking, as in speak,
speaking, spoke is used in another
context.

CHIOMA
Ah you're confusing me now.

Eddie comes to the door.

CHIOMA
Angela is teaching me how to --
(gives angela a knowing look)
Speaking-ing the big big oyibo.

ANGELA
It's work in progress

EDDIE
Teacher Angela, you remember you
have school tomorrow right?

ANGELA
Sorry Daddy, I'll go to bed now.

EDDIE
You should.

(to chioma)
Ok let her rest tomorrow you two
can continue.

CHIOMA
Ok Oga sir.
(to angela)
Step pikin sleep well you hear.

ANGELA
Good night.

Chioma stands up, and leaves the room.

EDDIE
Good night.

He shuts the door.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - CORRIDOR / OUTSIDE ANGELA'S BEDROOM -
CONTINUOUS

EDDIE
you seem to be getting along well
with Angela.

CHIOMA
(blushing)
Oga sir, we no go fit fight nau,
Angela na my step pikin.

Eddie's face suddenly go pale.

EDDIE
(sighs)
Chioma good night.

CHIOMA
You want me for the room tonight?

EDDIE
No, go to your room.

He walks away.

CHIOMA
Oga sir, good night you hear, good
night.

She skips away.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DAY

Angela is busy writing plans on a full scape sheet, Eddie enters.

ANGELA
(excited)
Daddy!

She runs over to hug Eddie.

EDDIE
How have you been.

Angela waves the paper at him.

ANGELA
See all my plans.

EDDIE
Plans for what?

ANGELA
My birthday.

Eddie takes the sheet and reads through.

EDDIE
You want your mom to attend?

ANGELA
Yes I sent her a message and she
promised she'll not miss my next
birthday.

EDDIE
That's this Friday, honey I'm not
sure your mom is even in the
country.

ANGELA
She'll fly in on time...she said
she was going to get me a Doll
house.

EDDIE
(dumbfounded)
Angela...baby...
(beat)
Ok, ok let's just hope she comes.

ANGELA
(not looking)
I'm also going to invite Auntie
Amara.

EDDIE
She's not going to come, she hasn't
been around since Chioma moved in.

ANGELA
But Chioma is not a bad person,
I'll tell Amara and she'll come.

EDDIE
Why do you think everything is
rainbows and unicorns, these things
are complicated, they're not going
to come to your birthday party!

A beat

ANGELA
(angry)
You just want me to be alone with
no friends just like you!

She snatches her sheet and leaves.

EDDIE
Angela, hon...

Sighs.

CUT TO

INT. FAMILY HOUSE- EDDIE'S ROOM - LATER

Eddie dials on his phone, phone buzzes, and the receiver
answers.

EDDIE
I didn't think you'd answer

TRISHA (V.O)
Are you sick in the head or
something?! Why would I not answer
my phone?

EDDIE
But-

TRISHA (V.O)
What is it ?!

EDDIE
Angela's birthday is on Friday,
this Friday.

TRISHA (V.O)
So?... I'll send you some money to
throw her a party.

EDDIE
No, no I can handle the bills, what
I called you for is to beg you in
the name of God to please come see
her, it's the only thing she wishes
for, she doesn't even want the
gifts, she just wants to see you,
her mother.

TRISHA (V.O)
Edison I'm working, tell you what
I'll send you three million.

EDDIE
You can't just throw money at all
your shortcomings...you need to
come or you'll, you'll break her
heart.

TRISHA (V.O)
Eddie it's not magic, I can't be
there by Friday not even if I
wanted to, which I don't, I mean
who celebrates birthdays anyways.

EDDIE
Trisha what kind of a person are
you?

TRISHA (V.O)
Next time you call you'll be
speaking to my Personal assistant,
take care I'll send you some money.

She ends the call.

EDDIE
Trisha!.

Takes the phone away from his ear.

CUT TO.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - EVENING

We pan round the house , birthday decorations hanging all
over there's a feast on the dinner table.

Eddie enters the room with several gift boxes and stacks

them on the center table.

Chioma brings a one layer cake with candles and places it on the table.

EDDIE
Wow it looks really good.

CHIOMA
(smiles sheepishly)
Chioma cooks and bakes too

EDDIE
Where's Angela?

CHIOMA
She's in room, wearing fine fine
cloth...me I wear my Christmas
cloth.

She waves her gown.

EDDIE
You're looking good yourself, let
me go check on her.

He hurries off.

CHIOMA
Oga sir say I look good, Oga Edison
Odiohon like me well well o.

She laughs.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - ANGELA'S BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Angela is all dressed in her birthday outfit, but she's sitting on her bed sad.

Eddie enters the room.

EDDIE
Honey everything is almost ready.

He stops , noticing her mood, he quietly sits next to her.

EDDIE
Angela, what's the matter?

She shrugs.

EDDIE

Don't you like the party? the camera man would be here any minute, all your friends from school are coming too... Is it the cake, should I get you another one?

ANGELA

I don't care about the party I want Mummy.

EDDIE

(sighs)

Look, she's going to come, maybe not now or today but she'll be here eventually, but before Mummy gets here, you can't just stay locked up in your room, people are waiting outside.

A beat

ANGELA

You don't have to lie about Mummy, I know she's not coming, she doesn't want to be with us...

(beat)

Aunty Amara is not coming either, nobody wants to be with us.

EDDIE

It's not like that, maybe something is keeping Amara...you know what forget them, if they don't want to be here then it's their loss, Angela I want you to always remember that you have me, come rain, come sun, I'll always be here for you, because I love you and that's all that matters.

He draws her up close for an embrace.

CUT TO.

INT.FAMILY HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Chioma jerks the door open, letting in guests: a mother and her two teenage daughters.

CHIOMA

(excited)

Una welcome to our house o

Angle on a CAMERA MAN setting up at the corner of the room.
Eddie leads Angela in.

EDDIE
The birthday girl is here!

Everyone begins to sing the "Happy Birthday Song"

EVERYONE
[Singing]

As they near conclusion.

CHIOMA
(louder than all)
Hip, hip,hip!...

The door suddenly creaks open, Trisha walks in, she's surprised to see the set up.

Everyone freezes.

ANGELA
(eyes wide)
Mommy?!

EDDIE
Oh my God you came?

TRISHA
The party is today?, jeez I forgot,
I thought it was till next week.

ANGELA
you forgot my birthday?... then why
are you here?

TRISHA
Your father here stubbornly refused
to waybill my documents over to
me...well I came to get them
myself...

Flicks dirt from her fingers.

ANGELA
(tears whirling)
You really don't care about me do
you?!

She runs off to her room.

TRISHA
What is wrong with her?

EDDIE
Trisha!

He drags her by the arm out of the living room.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - EDDIE'S ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Eddie slams the door shut and Trisha regains balance.

EDDIE
Did I offend you in any way?

TRISHA
No, except for being pesty, we're
ok.

EDDIE
(fuming)
Pesty? Your daughter hasn't seen
you in two months, Trisha. She's
been crying for her mother, and you
walk in here looking for
"documents"? Do you even know how
old she is today?

TRISHA
Don't start with the emotional
blackmail, Edison. I am here now,
aren't I? I'll give her some money
and we can—

Suddenly, a loud, upbeat Afrobeat track blares from the
living room.

INT.FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Eddie and Trisha enter. Amara is present and center stage,
followed by a DELIVERY GUY carrying in a massive three-
layered cake and several high end looking gift boxes.

Angela walks in with a look of surprise.

AMARA
(beaming)
Angelaaaa! Happy Birthday, my
favorite girl!

Angela's face lights up. She walks up to Amara.

AMARA
How could you guys have started
without me, don't you know I'm the
life of the party? No Amara no
vibes o.

ANGELA
I'm so glad you made it, the cake
is beautiful!

AMARA
Yes with all your favorite flavors.

Angela's mouth go wide.

Chioma stands by the corner, clutching her apron, looking
like she wants to spit.

CHIOMA
(low, to herself)
Ah. See enemy.

Angle on Eddie and Trisha watching.

TRISHA
(to eddie)
who is she?

Amara walks up to the duo.

AMARA
(to eddie, ignoring trisha)
I hope I'm not too late, Eddie. I
just had to make sure my outfit was
perfect.

She twirls, in front of Eddie, almost stumbling over and
falling on him.

AMARA
(giggles)
Oops

Trisha's face goes to "irritation" almost instantly.

Amara leans in and kisses Eddie's cheek, her lips lingering
dangerously close to the corner of his mouth. Trisha's jaw
drops.

CHIOMA
 (shoving in between them)
 Oga Edison! Come and see, the small
 children are hungry, come and help
 me share the food!

She drags Eddie across the room to the dining table.

Amara gives Trisha a "Up-down", shrugs and cat walks away deliberately flaunting her butt.

Trisha gawks dumbfounded.

The music cranks up. Close up on Eddie next to Chioma who's stuffing his mouth with cake.

EDDIE
 (mouthful)
 It's enough nau, you want me to
 finish the cake ?

CHIOMA
 (smiling sheepishly)
 You liking it abi?

Suddenly Amara grabs Eddie's hand, spinning him into a dance. She moves rhythmically, her body pressing against his.

Chioma doesn't back down; she drops the plate of cake and starts a heavy village style dance, bumping Amara away with her hip.

Amara bumps back.

Chioma returns even more aggressive, hoarding a protesting Eddie to herself.

Angle on Trisha, She exhales and heads for the bedroom.

The music dips.

Eddie breaks free from Chioma and Amara, he goes over to Angela who's talking with the other kids.

EDDIE
 come take some pictures with daddy.

He waves at the camera man, who instantly drops his plate of food and starts getting his camera ready.

Trisha returns, holding a hastily wrapped parcel.

TRISHA
Angela, wait. i have a gift too.

The room goes quiet. Angela takes the box. She opens it to find a pair of used, designer high heels.

ANGELA
(flatly)
Mummy... these are your old work shoes. They don't even fit me.

Awkward silence.

TRISHA
(timid)
you're a big girl now, you'll grow into it, right?
(to eddie)
Right?

AMARA
(soft voice)
Oh, of course she definitely will when she turns 30.

TRISHA
What?!

Amara signals her helper, who brings forward a sleek box.

AMARA
Here, sweetie. Something for a real athlete.

Hands it over to Angela.

Angela opens it. Her eyes widen at the sight of brand new Adidas sneakers.

ANGELA
(screaming)
Auntie Amara! I love them!

She dumps Trisha's shoes on the floor and throws her arms around Amara.

EDDIE
(to trisha, whispering)
Really, Trisha? Old shoes? That's the best you could do for your own daughter?

Chioma steps forward.

CHIOMA
 (announces)
 Wait o! I have my own gift!

Chioma presents a heavy, soot stained pot and two large wooden spoons, hands them to Angela who holds them up awkwardly.

CHIOMA
 Step pikin, my "Hilly Linda Abassy Nwa", see you nau, now you go fit cook all the many many correct soup wey I don teach you!

AMARA
 Oh my God, she's just a child...not everyone wants to end up like you... A common maid.

CHIOMA
 (flaring up)
 Who are you calling maid? You this husband-snatcher neighbor!

Eddie quickly signals the Camera Guy.

EDDIE
 Dj music!

The camera man runs over and switches up the stereo, the music erupts again.

Eddie grabs both women by the shoulders, forcing them into a silly dance to drown out the brewing war.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

The guests are gone. Trisha sits on the sofa, looking like a stranger in her own home.

Angela is cuddled up next to Amara on the other couch, showing her something on a phone.

Chioma is sweeping the floor, aggressively moving her broom over Trisha's feet.

TRISHA
 Hey! Watch where you're sweeping!

CHIOMA
 (without looking up)
 Party don finish some people no just want go house.

Chioma hisses then exits.

Angela stands up, yawns, and kisses Amara on the cheek.

ANGELA
Goodnight, Auntie Amara.

She walks past Trisha without a single glance as Eddie enters nursing a glass of water.

AMARA
(to eddie)
Eddie. My car is acting up again. I need to get some sleeping pills at the estate chemist... I haven't slept well in days. Could you please drive me?

She reaches out, rubbing her hand along Eddie's arm, her eyes locked on Trisha.

EDDIE
(looking at trisha's cold stare)
Uh... okay. Let's make it quick.

They exit. Trisha sits in the silence.

TRISHA
(whispering)
Have I... have I actually lost my marriage?

She pulls out her phone and dials.

TRISHA
(into phone)
Yes, it's me. Put all my appointments on hold...No...Q2 can wait. Everything can wait.

CUT TO:

EXT. ESTATE ROAD - NIGHT

Eddie exits the chemist with a small bag. He enters Amara's car.

EDDIE
(handing her the bag of drugs)
Here, the prescription is on the sachet.

Amara takes it with her eyes seductively locked in Eddie's.

AMARA
You're such a darling.

EDDIE
Let me take you home then.

He starts the car. They drive for thirty seconds before the engine coughs and dies.

EDDIE
What happened?
(he pulls on several buttons)
It was working fine just now.

AMARA
(leaning in close, her voice a silk
whisper)
Maybe the car just wants us to stay
here... alone. In the dark.

She lunges for a kiss. Eddie pushes her back, his face set.

EDDIE
No.

Amara moves halfway across the seat, almost on Eddie's laps.

AMARA
Come on, we've had an amazing day
so far, let's just have this one
moment to ourselves.

EDDIE
Amara, I said no.
(beat)
You know what?...
I'm walking home.

He gets out of the car.

AMARA
Wait don't go.

Eddie is now trekking away.

AMARA
(yells)
You're just going to leave me out
here?!

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - LATER

Trisha is pacing. The door opens. A sweaty, disheveled Eddie enters.

TRISHA
So? Did you enjoy the "sleeping pills"? Hmmm?

EDDIE
What is this all about?

TRISHA
You look exhausted, Edison. Did she work you that hard in the backseat?

EDDIE
Trisha, don't start. The car broke down...I had to trek

TRISHA
(yelling)
I am sick of it! I travel for a few weeks and you turn this house into a zoo! I mean where did all these people come from?!
you have a neighbor who can't keep her hands to herself and her fat ass out of my sight! and you have this village girl telling everyone she's your wife and Angela is her "step-pikin"! she hisses at me in my own house!

EDDIE
I'm going to bed.

TRISHA
No! You will listen!... Eddie ,
Eddie...Tomorrow morning, you are kicking that village girl out. And you will ban Amara from ever stepping foot here. Do it, or I am filing for divorce on grounds of infidelity!

Eddie stops. He turns slowly.

EDDIE
Fine. Get the divorce.

Trisha freezes.

EDDIE (CONT'D)

Everyone can finally be free. Get a divorce because I'm not kicking anyone out. If anyone should be banned, Trisha, it's you. You're a guest here. So don't act like you own the place.

TRISHA

My money

EDDIE

(yells)

My house!, my marriage!! and you are my wife!!!

TRISHA

You're yelling at me?

(fumes)

Don't you dare!

EDDIE

Or what?!

A beat

EDDIE

(low tone)

Now, don't come to the bedroom. Sleep on the couch, the floor, wherever, I don't care.

He enters the room and slams the door. Trisha bangs on it.

TRISHA

Edison! Open this door! You can't lock me out of my own bedroom!

The door cracks open. Eddie dumps a flat pillow and a thin duvet into her arms.

EDDIE

Goodnight, Madame.

The door is shut.

Trisha stands in the hallway, clutching the pillow. She looks at the couch. Suddenly feeling small.

FADE TO BLACK.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - MORNING

Trisha is sprawled on the couch, wrapped in the thin duvet.

Chioma enters, holding a bucket of soapy water. She hums a village tune, then starts flicking a wet rag aggressively.

A glob of soapy water hits Trisha's forehead.

TRISHA
(bolting up)
Are you mad?! What is wrong with
you?

CHIOMA
(nonchalant)
Oh! Madame is you? I been no see
you for there-

TRISHA
(cuts in)
Don't give me that crap, you're
obviously not blind!

She notices the rag in Chioma's hand.

TRISHA
Give me that.

She snatches the rag and spreads it open, it's a dress.

TRISHA
(shocked)
Chioma?!

CHIOMA
ehn!

TRISHA
(swings her hand at chioma)
You're cleaning with my designer
dress!

Chioma ducks evading Trisha and moves to the other end of the room.

CHIOMA
Which kind thing be this na, I
collecting rag from room and clean,
you want to slap me.

TRISHA
Does this look like a rag to you?

She holds up the dress.

CHIOMA
Ehen nau, see...see hole, hole
everywhere

She points at different partings in the dress's design.

TRISHA
Oh my God, you-!

She charges forward again, swinging at Chioma, Chioma catches her hands in mid air.

CHIOMA
Madame Tree Tree, I no minding Oga
Edison Odiohon o, I go beat you
black and blue.

TRISHA
Let go of my hands.

CHIOMA
no ever for your life, try this
yeye thing again...I go beat you,
use you chop sand...then I call my
grandmama for village, she nack you
bad juju.

Trisha breaks free retreating in fear.

CHIOMA
Now you know who is Madame in this
house!

She moves towards Trisha who backs up and falls butt first into the chair behind her, she curls up avoiding contact with Chioma.

Trisha looks at Chioma's intense eyes, genuinely horrified.

CHIOMA
For this house Edison Odiohon is my
man, my boo, he loving me scatter,
loving me pass you and I loving him
too... Madame Tree Tree no try me
O...
(she turns, walks, stops)
No try me!

She exits.

Trisha uncurls slowly.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DINING ROOM - LATER

Eddie and Angela are eating a steaming bowl of yam and egg sauce. Trisha enters.

TRISHA
Good morning...that looks delicious

EDDIE
(smiles)
Chioma is a darling.

A look of discomfort flashes across Trisha's face, she musters composure.

TRISHA
...is there any left?

Chioma enters with a frown.

EDDIE
(waving to the table pot)
Yes of course, just -

CHIOMA
(snatches the table pot away)
The yam has finished o.

EDDIE
Chioma there's food in that pot.

CHIOMA
It has finished.

EDDIE
Chioma!

TRISHA
Chioma I can see it!

CHIOMA
(to eddie)
Oga, the remaining one is for the dog.

ANGELA
We have a dog?

CHIOMA
Is the neighbors dogs, they have not eat siiiince.

TRISHA
You'd rather I starve while you feed dogs?

CHIOMA
Na me suppose feed you? Big Madame
like you, you want me to feeding
you like baby, Oya come and suck
breast.

Puffs up her chests.

EDDIE
Chioma please leave

CHIOMA
I want to feed her nau.

EDDIE
Go!

Chioma grumbles as she leaves the room.

Eddie stays silent, focusing on his food.

TRISHA
So...

EDDIE
Order something or better still
cook.

TRISHA
You know I don't cook.

EDDIE
well that's your problem, what kind
of a wife or mother doesn't cook?

Trisha sighs and walks away.

EXT. FAMILY HOUSE - MOMENTS LATER

Amara pulls up in a sleek SUV. She hops out, wearing a
tight gym set.

AMARA
(calling out)
Angela! Ready for school?

EDDIE
(coming out)
I thought your car was dead?

AMARA
 (purring)
 A miracle happened, Eddie. Just
 like the miracle of you looking so
 so handsome this morning.

She lunges forward, pinning Eddie against the car in a
 forced hug.

Trisha watches from the doorway, fuming. Amara winks at her
 over Eddie's shoulder.

TRISHA
 (snaps)
 That's my husband you bitch!

EDDIE
 Trisha!

AMARA
 Oh my God, what did I do?
 (mutters)
 So insecure, jeez

A beat

TRISHA
 (composing herself)
 Eddie!, can we talk?

EDDIE
 (untangling himself)
 I have a catering delivery, Trisha.
 I don't have time for ... your
 drama.

TRISHA
 (gasps)
 I am the one with drama?!

Angela comes out, Eddie let's her into the car, Eddie jumps
 in too, Amara smiles wicked as she enters the driver's
 seat.

TRISHA (CONT'D)
 You're literally cheating on me
 with our neighbor! And you want to
 make it about drama!

The car pulses forward, Trisha jumps out of the way, the
 window slides down.

AMARA
 My bad.

She laughs hysterically as she pulls out of the driveway and into the estate road.

EXT. ESTATE - EVENING

A drone shot of the residential area.

Street lights coming, some late walkers still in the curb.

We see Amara's car drive down, making a curve into her driveway.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Amara is sitting with Angela, helping with a school assignment.

Trisha sits on the opposite end, she's pretending to work on her phone, all the while watching the duo.

AMARA
So if you look at the equation
you'd know that you should multiply
it.

ANGELA
I don't understand, my teacher
said-

AMARA
(cuts in)
Your teacher isn't always right,
It's all about what you
know!...your teacher might just be
a dumb skull for all I care...
don't tell her I said that though.

Angela nods uneasily.

AMARA
Now write it the way I showed you.

TRISHA
Wrong

A beat.

AMARA
Excuse me?

Trisha stands up and approaches them, snatches the book, reads through.

TRISHA
This is a simple equation and
everything you've been doing here
is all wrong.

ANGELA
(neutral)
Yes I've been trying to -

Trisha shuns her

TRISHA
Trying to what?! You saw me your
mother in the house but you decided
to take your school work, your
precious education and put it in
the hands of touts, thieves and
school dropouts.

Amara shifts uneasily in her seat, Angela's face drops to
the floor.

ANGELA
She's not like that.

TRISHA
I have three bloody degrees, does
she have Waec certificate? You're
allowing illetrates who know
nothing but snatching married men
from their marriages to educate
you, you want to become a home
wrecker too abi.

Grabs Angela by both shoulders, shaking her.

TRISHA
You want to grow up and take after
this witch, you want to go after
people's children and husbands is
that it, is that what you're
learning from her.

ANGELA
(starts crying)
Mommy stop!

Amara stands up and breaks Angela away from Trisha's mad
hold, dragging her to her side.

AMARA
(yells)
Leave her alone... she's just a
child!

TRISHA
She's my child! And you are
destroying our family!

Trisha's hand connects with Amara's face. Trisha goes to strike again, but Angela jumps in between, Amara is protected, but Trisha hand brushes past Angela's cheek.

The room suddenly goes silent

Angela has her palms over her face.

ANGELA
(coldly)
Mummy Just leave us alone!

TRISHA
(frantic)
I'm not doing this, they're making
me do this, they want you to hate
me, they're turning me against you,
Angela please!

ANGELA
(yells)
Nobody wants you here, Mummy! Go
back to your office!

Trisha stands frozen as Angela hugs Amara crying.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Trisha is sitting on the couch, a large framed photo of herself, Eddie and Angela in hand.

She's crying profusely.

TRISHA
(mutters)
I'm sorry...

FADE OUT.

FADE IN:

INT.FAMILY HOUSE - MORNING

-Trisha wakes up from the couch, she packs up the duvet and pillows.

-Returns shortly after with a broom stick and starts sweeping.

-Trisha cleans the furniture with a rag.

-She takes a pile of dirty laundry across to the washing machine.

Angle on Chioma watching her, in surprise.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS

Trisha , apron slung on, sweaty, multi-tasking , the kitchen in full swing as prepares a pot of stew.

Adding some final seasonings to the steaming pot on the stove.

Her phone blazes, she answers, while slowly moving away from the gas, eventually out of the kitchen.

Chioma creeps in, holding a bag of salt. She pours half the bag into the pot, stirs it, and vanishes.

Trisha hurries back in and drops the pot.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DINNING ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Trisha serves the food with a broad smile.

Eddie and Angela are present at the table, expressions neutral.

TRISHA

I know things have been hard these past few days. So I made this as a promise to the both of you that I'll try my best to do more. I want to be a better wife and mother.

Eddie takes a bite. He immediately gags, reaching for water. Angela spits hers out.

EDDIE

Trisha... are you trying to give us hypertension? This is pure salt!

TRISHA

(tasting it, horrified)
I... I didn't...
(realization)

Chioma! It's Chioma! she spiked the food.

ANGELA
What?

EDDIE
What?

CHIOMA
(from the corner)
No call my name o! If you no sabi
cook don't blaming Chioma!

TRISHA
You were the only one who -

EDDIE
(cuts in)
It's ok, it's enough!
(low tone)
I'll buy fast food on our way out,
you don't need to fight each other
over it.

He waves to Angela. Angela stands up and follows Eddie out of the room.

Chioma laughs hysterically

CHIOMA
You want to replacing Chioma, Chi
Chi Baby, you die well.

Laughs some more , before leaving.

Trisha still baffled tastes the food again and spits it out.

EXT. FAMILY HOUSE-COMPOUND - DAY

Amara's car speeds into frame, she's back from the gym, she steps out in her skinny tights.

Trisha blocks her path.

AMARA
If you want to throw hands I can
assure you that I will not hold
anything back.

TRISHA

(stern)

Stay away from my daughter and husband. I know what you're doing, you're trying to turn them against me but it won't work.

AMARA

(laughing)

What am I doing? I'm winning. Eddie doesn't want a "Boss Lady" with an ugly, stressed out work body, look at you, you're washed up and finished, saggy old breasts and a piece of dirty ass. Eddie wants someone soft. Someone like me.

She twirls showing off her curves.

AMARA

and as for your daughter, I have Angela eating from the palm of my hands. You're just a ghost in this house, better start thinking of the retirement home you want to be sent to.

Trisha is dumbfounded , trembling,she walks away.

ANGELA

Auntie Amara you're back...can I come to your place?

AMARA

Of course you can, right this way.

She leads Angela towards the next building.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - CHIOMA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Chioma sits on her bed. She pulls out a medium bottle of Lord's Gin. She drops three mysterious pills into it, shakes it, and gulps it down.

CHIOMA

(eyes turning red)

Tonight na tonight! Oga Edison must see this village fire!

(grabs her boobs)

this sugar!

She shakes her chest

CHIOMA
(drinks some more)
Oga Edison must enter today, body no
be firewood. Let me wearing my sexy
wrapper.

Belches as she rummages through her bags of wrappers.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Trisha in heavy make up and very tight outfits, She is
trying to talk to Eddie, who's walking away.

TRISHA
Eddie, wait, wait, listen to me!

EDDIE
Please aren't you tired, since you
got back you've been about
everything... I'm starting to
prefer when you were not around.

TRISHA
Obviously, so you can be free to do
whatever you want with these women.

Eddie is irritated, he side steps her , Trisha grabs hold
of him.

TRISHA
Stop walking away, I really want us
to talk about this... I'm not a bad
person you know that.

A beat

EDDIE
Ok just get it over with, what
exactly do you have to say?

TRISHA
why Amara? Her education literally
ends on TikTok, She...she has a
fake body!

EDDIE
So bad mouthing Amara is the very
important thing you want to talk to
me about?

TRISHA

If you can choose someone like
Amara over me, it makes me wonder
if you ever loved me in the first
place!

(beat)

Is it my body, you don't think I'm
attractive? tell me!, don't you
like my shape or you think I'm not
big enough.

She gestures to her buttocks

Eddie opens his mouth about to say something.

TRISHA (CONT'D)

My friend got a bbl, she knows a
very good doctor, I can book an
appointment , whatever the size, I
can change my body for you, for
this marriage... Eddie i just want
you to talk to me, to look at me
the way you look at them, to enjoy
my food, my company, Eddie i just
want you to smile at me again?

She shows off her body.

EDDIE

(quietly)

Amara was here when I broke my leg,
Amara was here when Angela had a
fever. She attended Angela's
football match, she took her to get
ice scream afterwards, when I got
stressed from work she told me I
was going to be ok...and I've
never... read my lips I have never
had anything intimate with her...

(beat)

I don't know how you see things,
but it's not about your body it's
about what's in your heart.

She tries to kiss him. He pulls away, sighs defeat and
heads for the bedroom. She follows, desperate.

TRISHA

Eddie please come back, we can make
this work

They burst into the room and stop.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - EDDIE'S BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Chioma is lying on the bed in a transparent nightie, smelling of Gin.

CHIOMA
(slurring)
Edison! My husband! Come unto me!
let me show you what hot body can
do!

TRISHA
(gasping)
You're sleeping with the help too?!

EDDIE
(shocked)
Chioma, get out!

Chioma starts screaming and throwing pillows, dancing like a possessed woman.

EDDIE
Chioma I said leave this room!

He engages her, trying to drag her out, while she's planting kisses on his face.

Trisha runs out, collapsing into a squat in the hallway, sobbing.

TRISHA
God please, I'm sorry, help me
please, save my marriage.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - LATER

Eddie is staring at a pile of unpaid invoices for his catering business, he's worked out and exhausted.

Trisha walks in, spots the papers, proceeds to sit beside him.

TRISHA
Can I see them?.

EDDIE
(defensive)
I can handle it.

TRISHA
(softly)
I might not have big bumbum-

EDDIE
(exhausted)
it's not about your body -

TRISHA
Let me finish.
(beat)
I might not be a great cook, but
I'm an awesome business woman. So
let me help you.

Eddie reluctantly hands her the pile.

She starts crunching numbers on her phone's calculator.
Within minutes, she has organized everything.

EDDIE
(impressed)
You... you did that in like ten
minutes.

TRISHA
If you pay off all these
outstanding, your business is quite
very profitable.

EDDIE
food business is mostly 3x in
profit.

TRISHA
I want to invest in you, Eddie. You
could actually scale bigger, I was
just too blind to see it but you're
doing great as it is.

EDDIE
Thank you for the compliments...but
I rather not scale, if it becomes
too big , I won't be able to handle
my life at home with Angela along
side it, so I'm contented with what
I have.

He packs up, stands.

EDDIE
you should try to be yourself more
often, not competing with Amara or
Chioma or some rival CEO, just be
you, present , the Trisha I
married, all the time , that will
be a dream come true.

Trisha's smile dwindles a little, her phone rings, she checks the caller, it's "P.A".

She sighs.

CUT TO:

EXT. AMARA'S HOUSE - DAY

Amara paces the living room, her phone pressed against her ear, she's uneasy.

AMARA
(into phone)
Emeka, just give me more time,
seriously give me more time,
everywhere is blocked I have nobody
to turn to.

The doorbell rings.

AMARA
(into phone)
I have to get the door.

She hurries over and frantically jerks it open, Angela comes in with a food flask.

ANGELA
Auntie Amara I've been waiting for
you since 12 o'clock, you didn't
show up.

AMARA
(not listening)
Angela, yes , Angela, I'll...
(checks her phone)
Just sit here, I have to make a
call.

She runs out of the room.

Angela is a little confused, she drops the flask on the table and sits.

A beat.

Angela stands up and slowly trails Amara to the kitchen.

Angela stops by the door ease dropping.

We can hear Amara's voice as she's speaking to someone on the phone.

AMARA (V.O.)
 (into her phone)
 You're not the only person I'm
 owing, the bank is taking my house!
 Do you know how many letters
 they've sent me? Like If I don't
 pay up the money, I'm doomed!...I
 just need to scam Eddie some how...
 He has to pay and If he doesn't
 pay, I'll , I'll just fake a
 pregnancy. That always works on
 these soft men!...at least that
 would guarantee myself a roof over
 my head till everything blows out.

Angela's eyes go wide. Offended , she turns towards the
 front door about to leave, she stops abruptly, her eyes set
 on Amara's bag on the far side of the room.

Angela goes through the contents of the bag, finds several
 letters.

She hits on an envelope that reads " Emulsion MFB...Final
 Notice", Angela tucks it into her shorts and hurries out.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LATER

Knock on the door.

Trisha answers, it's Amara wearing a skimpy dress.

TRISHA
 You're not coming in here dressed
 like that.

AMARA
 Angela came around earlier, she
 left without saying goodbye.

TRISHA
 Same way you're leaving without
 saying one, turn around and go!

AMARA
 ...for the sake of your daughter.

TRISHA
 What is wrong with you, I am not
 letting you parade yourself like a
 prostitute in my matrimonial home.

Amara closes up to her.

AMARA
this prostitute body has been all
over your matrimonial bed, Eddie
loves-

Eddie walks into frame.

EDDIE
Amara how are you doing?.

Trisha is blocking the door. Amara instantly starts trying
to push past.

AMARA
Eddie! Help me! Trisha is attacking
me!

Eddie waves Trisha out of the way.

Amara slumps into Eddie's arms.

AMARA
She had her hands around my neck
and everything...I need help...I
need a massage.

Rubbing herself on Eddie.

TRISHA
I didn't even touch her.

Suddenly, they hear a strange rhythmic thumping from the
bedroom.

EDDIE
What's that sound?

Everyone is confused.

TRISHA
It's coming from the bedroom.

They run over.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - CHIOMA'S ROOM - CONTINUOUS

The door flies open. Eddie, Amara and Angela enter,
Chioma is in bed with a local DISPATCH DRIVER.

EDDIE

Chioma!

The driver jumps off her, he quickly starts getting into his uniform.

TRISHA

Is that, are you a dispatch driver?

Chioma sits in bed with a wrapper over her chest.

The driver runs out.

CHIOMA

No go nau! We never finishing it!!!

Amara bursts into laughter.

EDDIE

So this is what you do in my house.

CHIOMA

I open it for you, you no gree enter, Chioma finding another man to enter o.

EDDIE

Chioma, pack your things, you're going back to the village!

CHIOMA

Oga Edison Odiohon you go calm down o.

EDDIE

You either leave or I'll have you arrested!

Eddie charges out, Trisha follows, Amara does a mocking dance, Chioma throws a pillow at her.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Eddie is on the couch drinking, Trisha comes to sit next to him.

EDDIE

Please I'm not in the mood.

TRISHA
I'm not here to argue...
considering everything that has
happened today.

They keep quiet for a moment and starts laughing.

EDDIE
That girl is a character.

TRISHA
(mimics chioma)
She opening it for you...she
opening it for Oga Edison Odiohon.

EDDIE
(mimics chioma)
Oga sir ...

They laugh some more.

TRISHA
How did she even convince the
dispatch guy to sleep with her?

EDDIE
We should be more concerned of how
she snuck him inside without our
knowledge...
(beat)
For what it's worth, she's finally
out of my neck, I'll just have to
change my timetable so I can have
enough time to do some work in the
house.

TRISHA
No, no don't bother, I'm here, I
can handle everything.

EDDIE
(scoffs)
You, the next minute you're on a
trip to Ghana...tell me a new
story.

TRISHA
this is a new story,
(beat)
I've never been unwanted before, at
work, at home, everyone loves me,
but I realized you people were just
managing me, and the moment you saw
people who could treated you

better, you threw me out...

EDDIE

We just wanted you to love and appreciate us back, as much as we loved you... And Chioma and Amara are not even saints, Amara is always trying to make out with me, Chioma is just a menace.

TRISHA

But you choose them

EDDIE

They were here, they did the things you should be doing, you just traded this family for your company... like I'm your husband and I don't remember the last time I held you.

TRISHA

I'm sorry. I forgot that the most important "Board of Directors" is right here in this house.

Eddie smiles.

They kiss. It's passionate. Arms wrapping around each other.

Angle on Amara watching from a corner, her face twisted in rage.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE LIVING ROOM - NEXT MORNING

Eddie and Trisha are fast asleep on the couch, they had a passionate night.

Angela walks in.

ANGELA

Daddy, Daddy!

Eddie wakes up, Trisha comes to moments after.

EDDIE

Baby, good morning.

ANGELA

Chioma is not in her room and the food in the kitchen...everything is bad.

EDDIE
 Oh, yeah Chioma has gone back to
 the village...but not to worry
 you've got Mummy.

Trisha smiles.

Angela folds her arms in protest.

ANGELA
 But you know she can't do what
 Chioma does.

TRISHA
 yes...
 (stands up)
 That is why you're going to teach
 me.

ANGELA
 How to cook?

TRISHA
 Yes, your daddy will help too.

ANGELA
 Daddy?

EDDIE
 She's sorry honey, your mother just
 wants to make things right.

A long beat.

Angela switches her demeanor, more lighthearted.

ANGELA
 (playful. sassy)
 first all go and get dressed you
 can't be looking like this in my
 kitchen.

Eddie and Trisha laugh

TRISHA
 Ok. Madam.

ANGELA
 Call me chef.

TRISHA
 (amused)
 Chef

ANGELA
Let's go.

Angela leads the way across the room.

Suddenly Amara walks in, holding a pregnancy test strip.

AMARA
(announces)
Eddie... we're having a baby.

Eddie freezes. Trisha looks like she's been stabbed.

TRISHA
(tears falling)
are you kidding me?

EDDIE
This is a lie!

AMARA
why would I lie we've been
together, you're going to be the
father of my child.

TRISHA
I knew it, I knew it.

She runs into her room.

EDDIE
(to amara)
What is the meaning of this, I've
never touched you!

AMARA
well you can't deny that now, if I
say you impregnated me, Eddie
that's exactly what you did.

EDDIE
You're going to regret this.

He exits.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - LATER

Amara is typing on her phone.

Angela walks into frame.

ANGELA
Are you really having a baby for my
dad?

AMARA
(dismissive)
Angela not now

ANGELA
you're going to destroy their
marriage.

Feeling pestered-

AMARA
(yells)
I said don't talk to me!

A beat.

Trisha drags her bags into the room, Eddie is trying to get
her to stop.

TRISHA
I just need some time to myself.

EDDIE
Then you leave your bags behind,
why are you leaving now, she's
obviously lying.

TRISHA
you can't prove otherwise Eddie,
I've seen you with her.

EDDIE
I didn't cheat on you!

TRISHA
Just let me go... I've been a
terrible wife, you'll be happy with
her.

She drags her bags, Eddie grabs hold of them , trying to
stop her.

AMARA
Eddie let her go for God's sake!

ANGELA
(screaming)
Wait!

Angela holds up the bank letter.

ANGELA

She's a liar! I heard her on the phone the other day. She's broke! And look at this...this is proof she's in so much debt she's ready to do whatever it takes to get her hands on money... Daddy's money.

Eddie snatches the paper, reads.

EDDIE

You're loosing your house?

ANGELA

(to trisha)

Mom I've always been in this house and I can tell you that Daddy never lets her stay, he doesn't even pay her visits...Daddy can never betray you.

Amara turns pale.

AMARA

Give me that.

She scrambles for the letter.

AMARA

You little brat! We could have been together while you were at school you dim witted fool!

TRISHA

He works, my husband goes to work...

(composing herself)

Even if you're pregnant for Eddie... don't worry, you can keep the baby, we'll make provisions, but not under my roof...but I doubt you're even pregnant.

EDDIE

(pointing to the door)

Amara you've done enough, you need to leave.

AMARA

Eddie after everything we shared.

EDDIE

Get out before I lay hands on you!

AMARA
You all deserve each other.

Amara scurries out.

Beat

Eddie turns to Trisha.

EDDIE
"My husband goes to work".

She smiles

TRISHA
And he loves his family.

They hug. Angela joins the hug.

TRISHA
I'm sorry

EDDIE
I know, I'm sorry too, I shouldn't
have let them in.

ANGELA
I like us, like this.

CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE- MORNING

SUPER IMPOSED : ONE MONTH LATER

Trisha is in a simple wrap-dress. She's helping Eddie knot his tie properly. While he's sipping coffee from a mug. They are teasing and laughing.

TRISHA
Don't stain yourself.

She pecks him.

Angela walks in, wearing her uniform.

ANGELA
I'm ready

TRISHA
Don't forget your lunch.

She hands her a food flask.

Her phone rings, Caller ID;"HEAD OFFICE." She looks at Eddie, who is holding Angela. She smiles, slides the "Decline" button.

TRISHA
Let's hurry.

The trio file out of the house, door shuts.

FADE TO BLACK.

THE END.